



1697

OTTOMANS DEFEATED

The Ottoman Empire struggled to reverse the losses suffered after the failed 1683 Siege of Vienna. In 1697, Sultan Mustafa II led a large army northward to attack the Habsburg Austrian Empire. Crossing the River Tisza at Zenta, in what is now Serbia, the Ottoman forces were surprised by an army under Prince Eugene of Savoy and routed. The defeat confirmed Habsburg control of Hungary, expelling the Ottomans from central Europe.

◁ The Battle of Zenta, 1697

1699

▷ Fort Jesus,
Mombasa



1698

ARABS DOMINATE EAST AFRICA

During the second half of the 17th century, the Sultanate of Oman, a state on the Arabian Peninsula, replaced Portugal as the dominant power on the Swahili coast of east Africa. By the 1690s, Fort Jesus, at Mombasa in modern-day Kenya, was the sole remaining Portuguese stronghold in the region. Omani forces seized the fort in 1698 after a lengthy siege. Much of east Africa was to remain under Arab control for almost 200 years.

1698 A Russian revolt led by the *streltsy* (a military caste) is crushed by Tsar Peter



△ Creation of the Khalsa

1699

SIKHS FOUND THE KHALSA

The Sikhs of northern India felt threatened by the religious intolerance of the Muslim Mughal emperor Aurangzeb. Sikh Guru Gobind Singh, whose father had been executed by Aurangzeb, decided to create a warrior community, the Khalsa, to defend religious freedom. In 1699, the first Khalsa were “baptized” in a ceremony staged at Anandpur in the Punjab. Following a strict code of dress and behaviour, the Khalsa became the core of Sikhism.